



Over the years we have accumulated *lots* of stuff.

Our three children—aged 9, 8 and 6—have many ‘wants’, and love to compare to what they see other children get.

Yet I started to feel like I was drowning in it all . . . excess furniture, toys, baby things, books, kitchen gadgets I didn’t use. It all has to be stored and maintained, and tidying the house felt entirely unachievable!

Well, I decided to get serious in reducing the clutter.

We held our own ‘Family Treasure Hunt’—and got the kids to find things to sell that no longer brought them joy.

Matthew sold a toy truck and bulldozer, and Claire and Rachael sold their vintage double school desk that was too small. Because they were in good condition, they got nearly two-thirds of the value of what they would be worth new!

Of course, seeing it go to another home and not to waste is the primary motivation, but the cash is a (surprisingly big) bonus. What’s more, our daughter Claire was able to turn an ‘impossible’ \$300 target to buy a loft bed into a much more achievable \$100 by buying second-hand from e-Bay. She was very happy with the result!

But best of all, it’s given us the opportunity to have great conversations about whether ‘stuff’ actually makes you any happier—or whether it just